

Home Security Checklist

Simple, practical steps for a safer home

CHECKLIST

Walk through your home and check each item. Anything left unchecked goes in the action table at the bottom so it gets a name and a date. Review this checklist once a year and after moving, renovating, or any security incident.

Basic security habits

- ☐ Lock doors and windows every time you leave, even for a few minutes.
- ☐ Lock up at night and when everyone is in the back yard.
- ☐ Keep the garage door closed and locked when not in use.
- ☐ Do not open the door to unexpected visitors; talk through the door or a camera.
- ☐ Keep valuables and packages out of view from windows and the street.

Doors and windows

- ☐ Exterior doors are solid-core or metal with a working deadbolt.
- ☐ Strike plates and hinges use long (3-inch) screws into the frame.
- ☐ Sliding doors have a bar or pin so they cannot be lifted or forced.
- ☐ Windows latch securely; ground-floor windows have secondary locks.
- ☐ Door viewer, camera, or video doorbell lets you see visitors first.
- ☐ Broken glass, frames, and weather-stripping are repaired promptly.

Lighting and landscaping

- ☐ Entrances, driveway, and garage are lit from dusk to dawn.
- ☐ Motion lights cover side yards, back doors, and dark corners.
- ☐ Shrubs are trimmed below windows; tree limbs do not give roof access.
- ☐ House number is large, lit, and visible from the street for 911.

Interior and exterior security

- ☐ Alarm system (if any) is armed, tested, and codes are current.
- ☐ Cameras are working, aimed well, and recordings can be retrieved.
- ☐ Fences and gates close and latch; gate locks are in use.
- ☐ Sheds and outbuildings are locked; ladders are stored inside.
- ☐ Firearms and medications are locked and secured.

Tools, keys, and valuables

- ☐ No spare key under mats, rocks, or planters; give one to a trusted person.
- ☐ Locks are re-keyed after moving in or when a key is lost.
- ☐ Garage remotes are not left in vehicles parked outside.
- ☐ Tools that could force entry are stored and locked away.
- ☐ Valuables and key documents are in a safe or secure location.

Trusted neighbors and suspicious activity

- ☐ Know at least two neighbors and exchange contact information.
- ☐ Agree to watch each other's homes and collect packages when away.
- ☐ Note descriptions, vehicles, plates, and direction of travel.
- ☐ **Call 911** for a crime in progress or immediate danger; use the non-emergency line for other concerns.
- ☐ Do not confront a suspicious person yourself.



Property inventory reminder: Photograph valuables and record serial numbers, make/model, and receipts. Keep a copy outside the home (cloud storage or with a trusted person). See the Property Inventory Sheet.

Action plan *Items to fix, who will handle them, and when*

Item to address	Who will handle it	Target date / notes	Done